PETLONG MARK DAKHLING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A policy and development professional with over four years of experience in climate and energy policy research, technical writing, and stakeholder engagement across african governance contexts. My work cover tracking policy, regulatory, and geopolitical developments, conducting in-depth research and analysis, and translating findings into policy briefs, technical reports, and institutional recommendations for government and sector stakeholders. I have supported embedded advisory work within a state government ministry, contributed to ESG/ESMS framework development aligned to IFC Performance Standards, and researched Nigeria's critical minerals and clean-energy value chains. I care about how Africa manages its resources and I want to keep growing as a policy researcher in that space.

SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

- Policy research, analysis, and policy brief development
- Climate and energy policy research (climate adaptation, low-carbon energy, energy transition, critical minerals)
- Government and institutional coordination (state-level advisory)
- ESG/ESMS framework development (IFC Performance Standards)
- Stakeholder engagement, coordination, and meeting documentation
- Technical writing, concept notes, and grant and proposal writing support
- Programme planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation (M&E)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Climate Change and Energy Analyst | African Energy Council (AEC), Abuja, Nigeria | *August 2023 – Present*

- Draft policy briefs and technical reports on climate adaptation and low-carbon energy strategies, contributing to AEC's positioning with government and sector stakeholders.
- Analyzed national and regional energy and industrial policies to identify gaps and opportunities, informing AEC's advocacy and research work, including tracking developments relevant to critical minerals and clean-energy value chains, such as research contributed to the NLNG CO2 utilisation pre-feasibility study.
- Developed ESG governance frameworks and guidance documents, including ESMS documentation aligned to IFC Performance Standards, to help organisations align with sustainable finance standards, including the MedServe ESG/ESMS framework connected to NSIA financing.
- Authored 1000+ articles on energy developments across Africa by conducting in-depth research and analysis, translating complex industry issues into timely, accessible publications.
- Lead stakeholder engagement activities including workshops on sustainable energy and climate literacy, facilitating dialogue and generating actionable outputs; co-organised Plateau Climate Week, building government and multi-sector stakeholder partnerships in Plateau State.
- Led and managed a schools-based Sustainability Clubs initiative, engaging students in environmental projects and building a grassroots model for climate education.

Associate Technical Advisor (Consultant) | Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Management, Bauchi State | *January 2025 – November 2025*

- Operated in an embedded advisory capacity within a state government ministry, conducting governance and risk assessment research that integrated climate adaptation, social inclusion, and gender equity considerations to inform government policy and disaster response planning, working effectively and discreetly within a public-sector environment.

- Translated field evidence and research gathered from communities across the state into policy-focused analyses and recommendations for institutional reform and programme design.
- Coordinated multi-sector partnerships with government bodies, NGOs, and civil society to improve resource allocation and humanitarian assistance delivery, supporting greater coherence across relevant policy and institutional frameworks.
- Supported monitoring and evaluation activities and contributed to the planning and implementation of state-level government programmes.

Humanitarian Affairs and Development Coordinator (Volunteer) | Universal Peace and Violence Amelioration Centre (UPVAC) | *November 2022 – July 2023*

- Conducted field assessments in IDP camps to identify priority needs and integrate climate risk considerations, translating on-the-ground evidence into targeted programme interventions.
- Designed and delivered training workshops on public health and youth engagement, with community feedback that improved participation over time.
- Supported stakeholder engagement activities and strengthened institutional partnerships with local and international organisations.

SELECTED PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

- Sustainability Clubs in Schools (Founder & Lead) — AEC: Built and lead a schools-based climate education initiative engaging students in environmental projects.
- MedServe ESG/ESMS Framework (Contributor) — AEC: Contributed to ESMS development aligned to IFC Performance Standards PS1–8, connected to NSIA financing.
- NLNG CO2 Utilisation Pre-Feasibility Study (Contributor) — AEC: Contributed research and analysis to a pre-feasibility study on CO2 utilisation.

EDUCATION

Master of Laws (LLM), International Law — Near East University, Turkey — 2019 – 2021

Bachelor of Arts (BA), International Relations — Near East University, Turkey — 2015 – 2019

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- ISO 14001:2015 Environmental Management System Awareness — The Knights of Safety Academy — July 2026
- Introduction to IFRS S1: General Requirements for Disclosure of Sustainability-related Financial Disclosures — IFRS Foundation — December 2025
- Introduction to IFRS S2: Climate-related Disclosures — IFRS Foundation — November 2025
- Introduction to IFRS Sustainability Disclosure Standards — IFRS Foundation — November 2025
- ESG Reporting — The ESG Institute — October 2025
- Children and Climate Change — UNITAR — September 2025
- Strengthening Climate Adaptation and Resilience — UNITAR — August 2025
- Gender Equality and Human Rights in Climate Action and Renewable Energy — UNITAR — June 2025
- Developing Skills for Women Leadership in Climate Action — UNITAR — May 2025
- Synergizing Disaster Risk Reduction and Climate Change Adaptation — UNSSC — August 2024
- International Women's Health and Human Rights — Coursera — June 2024
- Planning for Climate Change in African Cities — Coursera — April 2024
- Global Energy and Climate Policy — Coursera — July 2023
- Politics and Economics of International Energy — Coursera — April 2023

PUBLICATIONS

- Dakhling, P. (2026). The Nigerian Face of the Climate Change Crisis. BellaNaija. June 10, 2026.
- Dakhling, P. (2025). How Important is COP30 to Africa and Nigeria? BellaNaija. November 6, 2025.
- Dakhling, P. (2025). Why You Should Care About Climate Change as a Nigerian. BellaNaija. June 19, 2025.
- Dikwal, Dr. C.M., Katlong, A., Stephen, A., Promise, O.I., Dung, D., Dakhling, P.M., Kiyani, A.M., & Kpason, O. (2024). African Energy Council Outlook 2024. African Energy Council.

PRESENTATIONS & SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- Panelist — "Just Transition and Green Industrialisation: Pathways for a Low-Carbon Future," webinar hosted by The Greener Picture (UNN). October 25, 2025.